

CRITICAL VIEWING During the Renaissance, artists often painted secular, or nonreligious, subjects in everyday settings. What do the details in this painting tell you about this woman's everyday life?

J. Paul Getty Museum, Los Angeles

Francesco Ubertini (1494–1557), known as Bacchiacca, was a Renaissance painter from Florence, Italy. This painting, *Portrait of a Woman with a Book of Music*, reflects the new styles and techniques employed by Renaissance artists. For example, look at the column and vase in this painting. By painting them proportionally smaller, Bacchiacca has produced the impression that these items are placed well behind the woman. This technique, called perspective, gives the illusion of depth and distance and helped Bacchiacca create a work that looks three-dimensional.

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2.2 Renaissance and Reformation

In the 1300s, a revolution began to brew in Europe. But this revolution didn't involve weapons and war. It involved ideas. People focused on the individual and believed every person had unlimited possibilities. These, indeed, were revolutionary ideas.

MAIN IDEA The Renaissance marked a time of curiosity, learning, experimentation, communication, and change.

REBIRTH OF ART AND LEARNING

Historians called the revolutionary movement that began at the end of the Middle Ages the **Renaissance**, which means "rebirth." The Renaissance originated in Italy and spread to other parts of Europe. The movement had its roots in the classical writings of ancient Greece and Rome and the philosophy of **humanism**. Humanists encouraged freedom of thought and the development of new ideas.

The Renaissance also saw the revival of elements of ancient Greek and Roman architecture, such as columns and arches. This revival enabled generations of artists and architects to achieve levels of artistic creation not seen in Europe for a thousand years. Painters such as Raphael and Michelangelo, and architects such as Brunelleschi, created works that still inspire awe in people today. **Leonardo da Vinci** is considered by many to be the ideal Renaissance figure. Leonardo not only painted artistic masterpieces, but he was also an inventor, sculptor, and architect. His studies of anatomy and other sciences proved to be ahead of their time.

The ideas of the Renaissance also had an effect on literature. In the mid-1400s, **Johann Gutenberg's** invention of the **printing press**, which used movable metal type to print pages, allowed for mass distribution of classical and humanist literary works. As the availability of printed materials increased, more people learned to read, and the philosophy of the Renaissance and humanist movement began to spread rapidly across Europe.

DIVISIONS IN THE CHURCH

Around the time of the Renaissance, the Catholic Church began to lose some of its power. Some members charged the Church with corruption and called for reform. This gradual progression toward change within the Church eventually led to the **Reformation**, a split from the Catholic Church that took place in the early 16th century. **Martin Luther**, a German pastor and university professor, led this movement. He believed biblical scripture was more important than the pope's authority. He also believed that Christians achieved God's favor through faith rather than by doing good works. Luther was eventually excommunicated, or expelled, from the Catholic Church for his teachings.

Followers of the Reformation became known as **Protestants**, and the Church split between the Protestants and Catholics. Over time, many different Protestant churches, called denominations, developed, each with its own set of beliefs within the framework of Christianity.

HISTORICAL THINKING

1. **READING CHECK** From which ancient cultures did the Renaissance receive inspiration?
2. **DESCRIBE** Why was the printing press such an important invention during the Renaissance?
3. **DRAW CONCLUSIONS** Why do you think the Catholic Church excommunicated Martin Luther?

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